

01-14-2025 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G1V3gUfe2tM
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Comprehensive Municipal & School Board Meeting Report

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:11:42](#) The presiding officer conducted a roll call to formally open the regular session of the school board.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heeter, Dr. Washford, Mr. Low, Mr. Urban.
 - **Members Absent:** Ms. Barnes Griffin.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. O'Neal.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:05:31](#) The meeting opened with a moment of silence, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance. This was followed by a musical performance from the North Side Middle School "Titians" Advanced Choir (directed by Mr. Deniston), performing the National Anthem and "Jazz Waltzes of the Sugar Plum Fairy."
- **Approval of Minutes:** (Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond the standard consent agenda voting procedures).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:12:30 Presentation: North Side Middle School Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Principal Mr. Williams (North Side Middle School).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Williams presented updates regarding North Side Middle School, highlighting:
 - Music program achievements (All-Music Award from ISMA, State Fair marching band competition first place).
 - Student population growth (approx. 625-650 projected) and a strong 90% retention rate.
 - Programs including the Purple Star designation, dual language program, Ball State University Professional Development School (PDS) partnership, Titan TV, Esports state championship, and the upcoming "Project Gear Up" in 2025.
 - Strategic goals focused on math, ELA (implementing the new science of reading/Amplify curriculum), attendance (aiming for 94%, currently hovering just above 90%), and behavior (notable drop in Out-of-School Suspensions).
 - The "Challenge Three" initiative encouraging student participation in at least three extracurricular activities/clubs.
 - Professional development focus, including monthly support for first-year teachers, quarterly learning walks, and staff appreciation.
 - Capital improvements: teaming model investment, gym floor renovation, improved Wi-Fi, ViewSonic display boards, Chromebook carts, and cell phone restriction policies.
- **Action & Disposition:** Informational presentation; received and filed.

00:43:07 Administrative Update: Superintendent's Report

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Reynolds reported on:
 - District attendance reaching a pre-COVID high (averaging ~93% district-wide, with high growth at elementary feeder schools like Greenwood, Longfellow, and Southview).
 - Athletic achievements, including female wrestlers competing in the inaugural IHSAA regional tournament and Central swim teams' conference success (girls 3rd place, boys winning the swimming conference championship).
 - A national Power School cybersecurity data breach impacting data hosted by Power School; families were notified via the quarterly newsletter and website.
 - Upcoming Martin Luther King Jr. weekend events, including the Youth Citizenship Award ceremony recognizing 28 students and the community breakfast at Ball State University.
 - Acknowledgment of School Board Appreciation Month.

- **Action & Disposition:** Informational report; received and filed.

00:50:02 Consent Agenda Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members and Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Board members questioned staffing vacancies in science departments at Southside Middle School, replacement support for Griswold (contracting with Melissa Burton), and part-time coverage for school psychologists.
- **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:03:06 Annual Financial Report (Calendar Year 2024)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Drome, Business Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Drome presented the 2024 end-of-year financial data:
 - State basic grant revenue received: slightly over \$47 million.
 - Payroll increased by slightly over \$2 million due to headcount and raises.
 - Long-term debts fully paid off in December (totaling over \$10.6 million for the year), including the football stadium, track, bleachers, and concession/restroom building.
 - Overall checkbook balance at the end of December: \$35.2 million.
 - Education fund balance: increased from \$15.3 million to \$15.5 million (positive surplus of \$197,000 for the year).
 - Outstanding state loan balance reduced from \$12 million to \$7.9 million (paid via state basic grant revenue reductions).
 - Rainy day fund balance: stands slightly over \$5 million, following a \$1.4 million transfer in December.
 - Discussion regarding the impact of property tax circuit breaker caps (costing the district approximately \$1 million annually) and upcoming legislative sessions regarding operating fund caps and transfer limits.
- **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:14:30 Annual Education-to-Operation Fund Transfer Authorization

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Drome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Annual statutory request for permission to transfer funds from the Education Fund to the Operation Fund (not to exceed 15% of total education fund revenue) during 2025, avoiding monthly authorization requests.
- **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:15:30 Adoption of School Calendar for 2026<U+2013>2027 School Year

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grim.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Grim presented the proposed 2026<U+2013>2027 school calendar based on committee work and a survey of 668 parents, students, and staff:

- Maintains 180 student days and 185 teacher days.
 - Fall break (5 days), winter break (2 weeks), and spring break (5 days) remain aligned with county schools.
 - School starts the second week of August (teachers August 10, students August 12) and ends before Memorial Day.
 - Built-in snow days in March, April, and May were removed to ensure the school year concludes prior to Memorial Day.
 - **Action & Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
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4. Board of Finance Meeting

(Convened immediately following regular agenda items) - **Appointment of Officers:** 01:21:09 Dr. Keith O'Neal appointed as Board of Finance President; Mr. Dave Heeter appointed as Board of Finance Secretary. - **Discussion:** Review of annual financial data, interest earned (\$683,000), cash balances, and state-required fiscal health indicators. - **Adjournment of Board of Finance:** 01:32:04 Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No open public comment period or citizen speakers were recorded during this portion of the meeting transcript.*
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Delivery dates announced for two ordered white activity buses (Feb/March 2025).
 - Upcoming planning meetings regarding the Fieldhouse boiler replacement project (bonding in 2025, work in 2026).
 - Completion expected in 2025 for Fieldhouse parking lots, stadium south restrooms/sanitary lines, and electrical upgrades funded by November 2024 bonds.
 - **Adjournment:** 01:33:01 Official adjournment approved by Voice Vote.
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